

RELIGION — AND — ENTERPRISE *Summit* ★ 2026



Her Ladyship Justice Prof.
Mrs. Olivia Anku-Tsedo

Theme:

Powering Ghana's Growth,
Harnessing Faith & Tradition for;

■ MSME's Growth ■ Digital Leap ■ Financial Inclusion



Nana Dr.
Appiagyei
Dankawoso I



Mrs. Kosi
Antwiwaa
Yankey-Ayeh



Rev. Dr.
Cyril G. K.
Fayose



Bishop Dr. Samuel
Nii-Noi Mensah.



FRIDAY 26TH JUNE 2026



OIL DOME - ACCRA



9:00AM - 1:00PM



BRIEF ON RELIGION AND ENTERPRISE SUMMIT

The main objective of this Summit is to join the United Nations in celebrating MSMEs on the continent and explore the role of faith-based and chieftaincy institutions, financial inclusion, trade, industry, and technology, in achieving the objectives of the 24-hour economy, especially under the “Fund 24” pillar of the 24-Hour Economy.

The summit is thus convened to discuss and review ways of bringing the religious and chieftaincy institutions in Ghana on board as strong MSME enablers addressing the challenges of Micro, Small and Medium-sized Enterprises in Ghana, with special focus on women and youth.

Religion remains one of the most influential social institutions shaping values, behaviour, and economic participation globally. According to the Pew Research Centre's Global Religious Landscape study, Christianity accounts for approximately 32% of the world's population, Islam 23%, Hinduism 15%, and Buddhism 7%, with the remaining share consisting of adherents of traditional/folk religions, smaller faiths, and the religiously unaffiliated. (Pew Research Centre).

In Sub-Saharan Africa, religion plays an even more dominant role in community and economic life. Current estimates show that 62% of the regional population identifies as Christian, 33% as Muslim, and the remaining 5% belong to traditional religions, minority religions, or have no religious affiliation. (Pew Research Centre – Religion in Sub-Saharan Africa).

Looking ahead, Africa's religious demographics are projected to expand rapidly over the next few decades. According to Pew's population projections, the number of Christians in Sub-Saharan Africa is expected to rise from 517 million in 2010 to over 1.1 billion by 2050, reflecting the continent's youthful population and high fertility rates. (Pew Research Centre – 2050 Projections)

Researchers have long established a strong relationship between religion and enterprise development, a subject increasingly explored in business-related disciplines such as marketing (e.g., Mathras et al., 2016) and organisational studies (e.g., Tracey, 2012). Earlier work by Dodd and Seaman (1998) further highlights that an individual's belief system influences entrepreneurial motivation, contact networks, and management behaviour, ultimately shaping how enterprises are founded and sustained.

Given these realities, religious institutions in Africa, including churches, mosques, and traditional and interfaith bodies, occupy a unique position as catalysts for enterprise development. Their moral authority, extensive social networks, and community-based structures offer practical pathways to support entrepreneurship, strengthen social capital, and enhance inclusive economic participation across the MSME ecosystem.

Consequently, this summit, seeks to explore and promote a strategic partnership among faith-based institutions, chieftaincy structures, and public and private sector actors within the MSME ecosystem

It is time for Ghana's religiosity to move from mere fraternity to function; from pageantry to purpose; from convocation to causative living; from over spiritualization to practical spiritual impact. This is especially important because faith-based institutions command the trust, loyalty, and participation of nearly all informal sector entrepreneurs, reaching a sizable proportion of adherents across every region of the country.

ORGANIZING PARTNERS



**AFRICA FUTURE
LEADERS INSTITUTE**
OF GLOBAL AFFAIRS

PROGRAM OUTLINE

- 9:00** **Opening Prayer:** Apostle Enoch Osafo
- 9:05** **Introduction of Chairperson:** MC _ Dr. Michael Armah
- 9:15** **Remarks by Chairperson:** Her Ladyship Justice Prof. Olivia Anku-Tsedé
- 9:25** **Welcome Address/Purpose of Gathering:** Dr. Emmanuel Dei-Tumi
- 9:35** **Performance: Spoken Word:** Ms. Adongo Gloria Asibi
- 9:45** **Keynote Address:** Bishop Samuel Nii-Noi Mensah
- 10:30** **Reflections by the Guest Speaker:** Nana Dr. Appiagyei Dankawoso I
- 10:50** **Panelist Intervention**
- Rev. Dr. Cyril G.K. Fayose
 - Mrs. Kosi Yankey-Ayeh
- 11:20** **Open Forum**
- 11:50** **Special Guest of Honour: Hon. Ahmed Ibrahim** _ Minister for Local Government, and Religious Affairs.
- 12:00** **Closing Remarks-** Her Ladyship Justice Prof. Olivia Anku-Tsedé
- 12:10** **Vote of Thanks-** Mr. Stanilaus Attionu
- 12:15** **Announcements-** MC _ Dr. Michael Armah
- 12:20** **Closing Prayer-** Mrs. Charity Kankam Hagan
- 12:25** **Networking and Refreshment**

SPEAKER PROFILES

SUMMIT CHAIRPERSON



Her Ladyship Justice Professor (Mrs.) Olivia Anku-Tsede is a Justice of the Court of Appeal of Ghana. She was called to the Ghana bar in 1995 and practiced as a corporate and commercial law lawyer for over 27 years.

Until her appointment onto the bench, she was the Legal Counsel of the University of Ghana as well as an Associate Professor of Regulation & Organisation in the University of Ghana Business School.

She holds a Ph.D Degree in law from the Manchester University School of Law. She also holds a Qualifying Certificate (BL) from the Ghana School of Law and a Bachelor of Laws degree (LLB) from the University of Ghana. She is certified by the General Teaching Council of Scotland as a Qualified Teacher in Business Management for higher education.

Justice Professor Anku-Tsede has served on a number of religious, public and private sector Boards and Committees. She has led a number of research teams that investigated matters concerning regulatory regimes, gender equality, public policy and social change.

Her research focuses on how rudimentary data affects public policy and has published extensively in a number of top international journals.

KEYNOTE SPEAKER



Bishop Dr Samuel Nii-Noi Mensah is the Former President and currently the Chairman of the Board of Trustees of the Full Gospel Church International in Ghana, a fellow of the Institute of Directors, Ghana, a fellow and first Vice President of the Organisation Development Practitioners Association, Ghana. Dr. S.N. Mensah is a Leadership Development, Transition and succession management consultant of international repute.

He is the Founder and CEO of Omega Consultancy Services and Samuel Mensah Ministries. Bishop Mensah is also a former National Executive Council Member of the Ghana Pentecostal and Charismatic Council (GPCC). Bishop Dr Mensah is also the Patron of the University Students Association of Ghana (USAG)

Dr. Samuel Noi Mensah stands as a prominent figure in his contribution to national development in Ghana. With a distinguished career spanning over four decades, he has gained a reputation as a statesman. Driven by a desire to uplift communities and nations, Dr. Mensah leverages his expertise in social policy, organizational development, governance, and leadership to empower individuals and organizations towards a brighter future.

His social policy advocacy promotes inclusive growth, equitable opportunities, and sustainable development. His guidance in governance and leadership has empowered governments, organizations, and institutions to navigate their challenges and achieve their full potential.

He is just not a passionate patriot dedicated to advancing the socio-economic fabric of his nation but his advocacy for national development transcends borders, inspiring policymakers, entrepreneurs, and citizens alike to actively contribute to the collective growth and prosperity of nations.

Dr Mensah has received, numerous awards: Excellence in Pastoral & Apostolic Leadership from Global Leadership Training Institute, New York, USA in 2009, Best Student, Master of Governance & Leadership (GIMPA) in 2012, West Africa Noble Forum in 2017, Africa International Award of Merit in 2018, 2021 Ghanaweb Advocate of Good governance and 2021 best preacher of the year by the West African magazine.

GUEST SPEAKER



Nana Dr. Appiagyeyi Dankawoso I

was enstooled as Omanhene Kyeame of Juaben Traditional Area in January 2008, by Nana Otuo Siriboe II, the Omanhene of Juaben Traditional Area and Chairman of Council of State-Ghana.

Nana is a family man who is happily married.

He is staunch member of the Methodist Church and has served the Church in several capacities including Youth Chairman and Choirmaster roles which he executed effectively to the admiration of all.

Nana played a key role in the formation of the Ntonso and Kwadaso Nsoun Methodist Church Choirs. He is currently the Chairman of the Harvest Committee at Mount Olivet Church, Dansoman.

Nana is the President-General of the West Africa Nobles Forum (WANF) and the immediate past President of the Ghana National Chamber of Commerce and Industry (GNCCI). He is also the Former President of the Pan African Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PACCI) which comprises fifty-four (54) countries.

He Holds an Honorary Doctorate Degree in Financial Management from the Dayspring University, United States of America, a Master's degree in Financial Management from GIMPA and a Bachelor of Arts in Social Sciences from the University of Cape Coast.

Nana is a Chartered Insurer with about two decades' experience in insurance practice. Nana Dr. Appiagyei Dankawoso I serves on several governing Boards of prestigious brands.

Nana's support to God's work has been recognized by the Methodist Church Ghana and other Churches as he was a proud recipient of the 2021 Bishop's Badge from the Konongo-Mampong Diocese of Anglican Church and a Special Award from the Methodist Church California, Los Angeles

He is a passionate philanthropist who currently supports over five hundred (500) widows and has over the past five (5) years adopted the Kumasi and Nsawam prisons where he spends his birthdays with the inmates every year.

Nana has led business delegations to Abuja – Nigeria, Belgium, China, India, Geneva, Switzerland, Italy (Rome, Treviso and Torino), California, New York (One District-One Factory – US EXIM), Washington DC (AGOA), Gambia and many others.

PANELIST



Kosi Antwiwaa Yankey-Ayeh

Founder & Visionary Leader, KAYA Women's Leadership Institute.

Kosi Antwiwaa Yankey-Ayeh is a globally respected leader in economic development, strategic finance, and entrepreneurship, with over two decades of experience across Africa, North America, and Europe. She is the founding CEO of the Ghana Enterprises Agency (GEA)—Ghana's national authority for Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)—and the first woman to lead the institution.

Under her transformative leadership, the GEA supported over 1 million businesses and individuals, expanded its funding from approximately GHC 5 million to GHC 2 billion, and created Ghana's largest women's entrepreneurship platform, the WERise Network.

Kosi began her career on Wall Street at Deutsche Bank, where she helped structure the first microfinance fund by a global investment bank, and went on to serve in impactful roles at Solidaridad, and Engineers Without Borders, Canada. An entrepreneur at heart, she started her own consultancy, finance and agribusiness in Ghana with an Africa focus. Her expertise spans entrepreneurship, finance, MSME development, policy design, and large-scale project execution.

She has advised national and international institutions and governments, serving on boards such as the Ghana Venture Capital Trust Fund, the Ministry of Finance Advisory Board, the

Ghana College of Physicians and Surgeons Endowment Fund, and the Alliance for Integrity (Ghana and International Chapter). Her collaborations with the Mastercard Foundation include designing the Young Africa Works strategy and the Business in a Box initiative, which will in total train over 300,000 young people and create or sustain more than 200,000 jobs in Ghana.

Kosi holds a Master's in Public Administration and a Certificate in Public Policy from the Harvard Kennedy School, where she received the 2016 Excellence Award for Academic Distinction and the "Harvard Square to Oval Office" grant supporting Ghanaian women in politics. She earned her BA in Government and Certificate in International Relations from Wesleyan University, USA, and has further qualifications from Wageningen University (Netherlands), the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), and IE University (Spain), where she also lectures part-time.

A passionate advocate for women's empowerment, youth inclusion, and Africa's transformation, Kosi is a sought-after keynote speaker and mentor. She is a devout Catholic, married with three children, and continues to inspire women and girls worldwide through her bold vision, inclusive leadership, and unwavering commitment to creating opportunities for others to thrive.

PANELIST



Rev. Dr. Cyril G.K. Fayose

General Secretary of the Christian Council of Ghana. Rev. Dr. Cyril G. K. Fayose, a senior clergy person of the Evangelical Presbyterian (E.P) Church Ghana, and currently the General Secretary of the Christian Council of Ghana. Prior to his appointment, Dr. Fayose was the President of the Evangelical Presbyterian University College at Ho in the Volta Region of Ghana.

He is also a former President of the Trinity Theological Seminary in Legon, Accra and a former Board Member of the National Accreditation Board.

He has over the years served in various capacities as a minister of the gospel. He has pastored a number of Evangelical Presbyterian Churches including the E.P Churches in Adenta, Abelenkpe, Nima, the First Lutheran Church, Alexandria, Minnesota, and the Trinity United Church, Legon.

Dr. Cyril Fayose also served as the Director of the National Counselling Centre of the Evangelical Presbyterian Church, Ghana between 2006 and 2011. During that period, he was also an Executive Committee and Finance and Administration Committee Member of the Christian Council of Ghana

Rev. Dr. Cyril Gershon K. Fayose attended the Trinity Theological Seminary for his Bachelor of Arts in Psychology and Religion. After his first degree he enrolled at the University of Ghana and obtained a Master of Arts in Industrial/Organizational Psychology. From the

University of Ghana, he continued to the University of Dubuque Theological Seminary where he obtained Master of Arts in Religion with concentration in Pastoral Care and Counselling. In his quest to further his education, he attended the Luther Seminary, St. Paul, MN where he graduated with a Doctor of Philosophy (PHD) in Pastoral Theology.

Rev. Dr. Fayose is married to Mrs. Marylinda Semabia Fayose and they are blessed with four adult children.

SUMMIT DECLARATION

As this Summit concludes, the work continues.

The conversations, partnerships, and commitments forged here are only the beginning of a collective effort to mobilize Faith-based institutions and Chieftaincy systems to empower the enterprise ecosystem, and advance Ghana's economic transformation.

We invite you to remain engaged, champion the cause, and join us in the journey ahead.

THANK YOU